FY 2026 Education and Workforce Development NOFO Additional Information for Part IV, C

2/2026 Update: Page 33 - 34:Addition of Mentor and Reference Letters (Pre and Post-doctoral Fellowships)

Note that the required content and forms for applications vary by the program area priority described in the NOFO. Along with the information on this first page, see the appropriate program area priority section for relevant details:

PART IV—APPLICATION AND SUBMISSION INFORMATION

C. Content and Form of Application Submission

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In addition to the information in the AFRI Education and Workforce Development NOFO, additional AFRI specific application instructions can be found below. **All application attachments must be in a portable document format (PDF). Supporting information referenced throughout this Part IV.C. can be found at the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide, also included in the grants.gov application package.**

Using the bookmark feature in your PDF reader will allow you to navigate easily to the different sections in this document.

1) **SF 424 R&R Cover Sheet**
   Information related to the questions on this form are explained in detail in Part V.130 Field 4 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide. See Part V.100 Field 17 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for the required certifications and assurances (e.g., Prohibition Against Entities Requiring Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements).
2) **SF 424 R&R Project/Performance Site Location(s)**
   Detailed information related to the questions on this form is dealt with in detail in Part V.110 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.
3) **R&R Other Project Information Form**
   Detailed information related to the questions on this form is dealt with in detail in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

A. Field 7. Project Summary/Abstract

1. Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'.

The summary should explain the relevance of the project to the goals of the Program Area or Program Area Priority within this NOFO to which the application is submitted. See Part V.120 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

The following instructions are in addition to those included in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following**:**

1) Project title;
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority area focus of the project by selecting one of the following:
   a. Plant health and production and plant products;
   b. Animal health and production and animal products;
   c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
   d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
   e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
   f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.
3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project;
7) Location(s) (schools, colleges, universities, national labs, field stations, etc.) at which the proposed professional development activities will occur;
8) Facilitator to participant ratio;
9) Number of participants per year; and

In addition to the information requested above, please provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract. The abstract should briefly describe the project's objectives, activities, education professionals to be recruited, and intended impact. The abstract should also include the relevance of the project to the goals of the PDAL program area.

2. Agricultural Workforce Training grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'.

The summary should explain the relevance of the project to the goals of the Program Area or Program Area Priority within this NOFO to which the application is submitted. See Part V.120 field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

The following instructions are in addition to those included in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following**:**

1) Project title;
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority area focus of the project by selecting one of the following:
   a. Plant health and production and plant products;
   b. Animal health and production and animal products;
   c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
   d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
   e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
   f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.
3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project;
7) Name or type of industry-accepted credential the project will generate or participants will achieve;
8) Number of expected participants per year; and
9) Location(s) (colleges, businesses, etc.) at which the proposed activities will occur.

In addition to the information requested above, please provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract. The abstract should briefly describe the project's objectives, activities, participants to be recruited (if applicable), and intended impact. The abstract should also include the relevance of the project to the goals of the Agricultural Workforce Training program area.

3. Food and Agriculture Non-formal Education grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'. See Part V.120 Field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following:

1) Project title
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area focus of the project by selecting one of the following:

a. Plant health and production and plant products;
b. Animal health and production and animal products;
c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.

3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project;
7) Location(s) (universities, national labs, field stations, etc.) at which the proposed activities will occur;
8) Technology being addressed;
9) Number of participants per year;
10) Relevance of the project to the goals of Food and Agriculture Non-formal Education (FANE) program area; and
11) Relevance of the project to the goals of FANE Program.

In addition to the information requested above please provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract. The abstract should briefly describe the project's objectives, activities, and participants to be recruited, and intended impact.

4. Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'. See Part V.120 Field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

For **REEU project applications**, the Project Summary **must** indicate the following:

1) Project title
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area focus of the project by selecting one of the following six Farm Bill Priority Areas.
   a. Plant health and production and plant products;
   b. Animal health and production and animal products;

c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.

3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project's operation;
7) Location(s) (universities, national labs, field stations, etc.) at which the proposed undergraduate research and/or extension will occur;
8) Main field(s) and sub-field(s) of the research and/or extension;
9) Number of mentors;
10) Mentor to participant ratio;
11) Number of undergraduate participants per year;
12) Percentage of undergraduate students from the host institution;
13) Number of weeks per year that the students will participate;
14) Relevance of the project to the goals of REEU program area; and
15) Relevance of the project to the goals of AFRI Education and Workforce Development (EWD); and
16) Provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract that briefly describes the project's objectives, activities, and students to be recruited, and intended impact.

5. Pre-and Post-doctoral Fellowships grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'. See Part V.120 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template. The summary should be a maximum of one page and approximately 250 words.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following:

1) Names and institutions of the PD and Primary Mentor (more than one if Integrated project only);
2) Predoctoral (program code A7101) or Postdoctoral (program code A7201) application;
3) Project type (research, education, extension, or integrated research, education and/or extension) and concise project description in the applicant's proposed predoctoral program or postdoctoral training;
4) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area focus of the project

by selecting one of the following:

a. Plant health and production and plant products;
b. Animal health and production and animal products;
c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.

5) Relevance of the proposal to the goals of pre- or post-doctoral program area;
6) Relevance of the proposal to the goals of AFRI Education and Workforce Development (EWD).
7) ***Postdoctoral applicants ONLY:***
   a. Indicate the Program Area Priority Name and Program Code from the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science request for applications that most closely topically matches the proposed project.
   b. A table of the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Program Area Priority Names and Program Codes is listed below (Table 1) and can be found on the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Program funding opportunity page.
   c. ***Submit the application with the Postdoctoral Fellowship program code A7201 on the SF424.***
   d. Postdoctoral proposals will be reviewed by a respective AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Program Area.

Table 1: Program Area Priorities

The Program Area Priorities are summarized as follows:

Program Area[1]	Program Code	Program Area Priority Name
PHPPP	A1102	1a. Foundational Knowledge of Agricultural Production Systems
PHPPP	A1103	1b. Foundational Knowledge of Plant Products
PHPPP	A1112	1c. Pests and Beneficial Species in Agricultural Production Systems
PHPPP	A1152	1d. Physiology of Agricultural Plants
PHPPP	A1141	1e. Plant Breeding for Agricultural Production
PHPPP	A1113	1f. Pollinator Health: Research and Application
PHPPP	A1143	1g. Conventional Plant Breeding for Cultivar Development
AHPAP	A1211	2a. Animal Reproduction
AHPAP	A1231	2b. Animal Nutrition, Growth and Lactation
AHPAP	A1251	2c. Welfare of Agricultural Animals

AHPAP	A1221	2d. Diseases of Agricultural Animals
AHPAP	A1201	2e. Animal Breeding, Genetics, and Genomics
FSNH	A1332	3a. Food Safety and Defense
FSNH	A1364	3b. Innovations in Food Manufacturing Technologies
FSNH	A1344	3c. Diet, Nutrition, and the Prevention of Chronic Diseases
FSNH	A1343	3d. Food and Human Health
FSNH	A1366	3e. Mitigating Antimicrobial Resistance Across the Food Chain
BNRE	A1401	4a. Soil Health
BNRE	A1411	4b. Water Quantity and Quality
BNRE	A1414	4c. Bioeconomy and Biobased Products
BNRE	A1451	4d. Landscape-Scale Production Systems
AST	A1521	5a. Engineering for Agricultural Production and Processing
AST	A1531	5b. Biorefining and Biomanufacturing
AST	A1511	5c. Nanotechnology for Agricultural and Food Systems
AST	A1551	5d. Engineering for Precision Crop and Water Management
AERC	A1601	6a. Small and Medium-Sized Farms
AERC	A1641	6b. Economics, Markets and Trade
AERC	A1642	6c. Social Implications of Food and Agricultural Technologies
AERC	A1661	6d. Rural Economic Development
AERC	A1651	6e. Environmental and Natural Resource Economics
Crosscutting	A1402	7a. Agricultural Microbiomes in Plant Systems and Natural Resources
Crosscutting	A1701	7b. Critical Agricultural Research and Extension (CARE)
Crosscutting	A1541	7c. Data Science for Food and Agricultural Systems (DSFAS)
Crosscutting	A1181	7d. Agricultural Biosecurity
Crosscutting	A1713	7e. Rapid Response to Emerging and Re-emerging Pest and Disease Events Across Food and Agricultural Systems
Crosscutting	A1811	7f. AFRI Commodity Board Co-funding Topics
Crosscutting	A1712	7g. Rapid Response to Weather Events Across Food and Agricultural Systems

[1] PHPPP=Plant Health and Production and Plant Products, AHPAP=Animal Health and Production and Animal Products; FSNH=Food Safety, Nutrition, and Health; BNRE=Bioenergy, Natural Resources, and Environment; AST=Agriculture Systems and Technology; AERC=Agriculture Economics and Rural Communities; Crosscutting=Crosscutting Program Area Priorities

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6. **Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants**
   Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'.

The summary should also include the relevance of the project to the goals of the Program Area or Program Area Priority within this NOFO to which the application is submitted. See Part V.120 Field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions. The suggested template for the Project Summary is located on the NIFA Application Support Templates page "Project Summary" in the attachments list. The project summary should be maximum 1-page and approximately 250 words.

B. Field 8. Project Narrative

1. Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative may not exceed ten-pages of written text using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative must include all of the following:

1) **Specific Application Type Information**
   a. Resubmissions – Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO.)
   b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
      i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative below.
      ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
2) **Overview**
   a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the PDAL program to be developed. What AFRI Priority Area(s) is (are) being addressed;

who are the intended participants; what skills gaps and/or academic challenges are being addressed; and what student outcomes will be impacted.

b. Project Justification: Summarize the body of knowledge justifying the need for the proposed project. Describe any ongoing or recently completed, significant activities related to the proposed project. If this application builds upon a previously awarded PDAL grant, please include information about prior program accomplishments, evaluation outcomes, and how the current proposal is innovative and not duplicative of previous awards.

3) Approach

a. Approach to K-14 food and agricultural sciences professional development
   i) Describe the type and details of how immersive learning experiences will be provided for K-14 educational professionals.
   ii) Describe the proposal's creative approach to K-14 professional development in the food and agricultural sciences. Using either actual experiences or literature, show why you selected this approach.

b. Plan of Operation and Methodology
   i) Provide detailed description of the research, education and/or extension participant activities that will be pursued. How will these experiences lead to enhanced student outcomes?
   ii) Describe procedures for accomplishing the objectives of the project. Describe plans for management of the project to ensure its proper and efficient administration. Describe the way in which resources and personnel will be used to conduct the project.
   iii) Identify all important project milestones (performance metrics that indicate when project goals will be met) and dates as they relate to project start-up, execution, evaluation, dissemination, and closeout.

c. Recruitment, Selection, and Continued Support for K-14 Educators
   i) The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible, including the types and/or names of academic institutions where educational professionals will be recruited and the efforts that will be made to attract educators from low-resource schools.
   ii) Describe the criteria that will be used to select participants.

iii) Indicate how participants, who leave the program early, will be replaced.
iv) Describe additional support that will be provided to participants after the project ends.

4) **The Research, Education and/or Extension Environment**
   a. Describe the experience of the key personnel in providing quality immersive, experiential learning experiences in the food and agricultural sciences and training in the most effective pedagogical strategies for K-14 education.
   b. Describe the institutional support/partnerships for the proposed training. How does the proposed project align with and contribute to applicant and partner institutions' goals for enhancing K-14 education in their community/state/region?
   c. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for participants with disabilities, accessibility, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.
5) **Project Evaluation and Reporting**
   a. Clearly define a plan with a timeline to extensively evaluate the project using formative and summative assessment tools that can help inform future implementations of immersive learning based professional development programs. Identify pitfalls and limitations to the proposed approach and how these will be addressed.
   b. Define the approach for evaluating both participant (educator) and K-14 student outcomes.
6) **Expected Outputs**
   Please use the format provided below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of products to be developed through grant funds during the grant period (i.e., curricula, academic programs, recruitment/retention programs, materials,	
(2) Number of K-14 education professionals supported by this grant for professional development during the grant period	

(3) Number of students who will indirectly benefit from the products produced from the grant during the grant period (i.e., using the curriculum/instrumentation).	

2. Agricultural Workforce Training grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative may not exceed ten-pages of written text using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative attachment must include all of the following:

1) Specific Application Type Information

a. Resubmissions – Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO.)
b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
   i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative below.
   ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.

2) Overview

a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the program to be developed. The AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area(s) and workforce need being addressed; the anticipated project audience; and the project's objectives.
b. Summarize the body of knowledge justifying the need for the

proposed project. Describe any ongoing or recently completed, significant activities related to the proposed project.

3) **Approach**

a. Curriculum Development Mechanisms

i) For Design Projects: Describe what elements of curriculum development for workforce training the project will pursue. Curriculum development can include and is not limited to creation of curriculum and instructional delivery systems, pilot testing/ implementation of curriculum and delivery methods, development of assessment tools, and evaluation.

ii) For Implementation Projects: Describe the need to update or expand existing curriculum or training programs. In these projects, updating or expansion of curriculum is limited to the first year of the project with the remaining time being allocated for student training.

iii) Describe the industry-accepted credential(s) the project is to generate and/or participants are to obtain after participation in the project; include the applicability and potential pitfalls generating or obtaining such credential(s). Describe the need for such credential and current buy-in from industry or other groups who may seek to hire the students who obtain the credential.

iv) Describe the proposal's creative approach to agricultural workforce training. Using either actual experiences or literature, show why you selected this approach.

b. Plan of Operation and Methodology

Applications should provide detailed descriptions of the education activities that will be pursued. This discussion should indicate how these activities will lead to enhanced agricultural workforce training.

i) Describe procedures for accomplishing the objectives of the project.

ii) Describe plans for management of the project to ensure its proper and efficient administration.

iii) Describe the way in which resources and personnel will be used to conduct the project.

iv) Identify all important project milestones (performance metrics that indicate when project goals will be met) and dates as they

relate to project start-up, execution, evaluation, dissemination, and closeout.

v) For Implementation projects: Recruitment, Selection, Mentoring, and Continued Support for Participants. The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible. How will participants be recruited? What criteria will be used to select participants? How will participants, who leave the program early, be replaced? What additional support will be provided to participants after the project ends? While a mentoring plan is required for this program (see section F. Field 12. Other Attachments below), within this section describe how the mentoring activities occur throughout the project and are part of the student learning.

4) The Education Environment

a. Describe the experience of the key personnel in providing quality agricultural workforce training and creating/implementing curricula for the same.

b. Fully describe the Institutional Support/Partnerships for the proposed training. How does the proposed project align with and contribute to the applicant and partner institutions' goals for enhancing workforce training in their community/state/region? Projects that involve partnerships with local government, economic development organizations, and workforce-focused nonprofit organizations are encouraged.

c. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for participants with disabilities, accessibility, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.

5) Project Evaluation and Reporting

a. Proposals should include a clear internal evaluation plan which describes measures and methods for collecting and analyzing primarily student-focused outcomes and impacts, including metrics/indicators, to determine the extent to which the stated objectives have been achieved. Metrics to be captured include, but are not limited to the number of on-the-job training opportunities, students completing and acquiring the credential, students being placed in jobs after acquiring the credential, etc. Please be as specific as possible in describing the linkages among activities, outputs, and different types of outcomes (e.g., changes in participant

knowledge and awareness of careers in agriculture and training and employment opportunities) and the relevance and potential impact on successfully preparing and supporting students and other communities of learners to enter the future food and agricultural workforce.

b. Identify pitfalls and limitations to proposed approaches and how these will be addressed.
c. As applicable, define the approach for evaluating participant outcomes.

6) Expected Outputs

Please use the format provided below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of products to be developed through grant funds during the grant period (i.e., curricula, academic programs, recruitment/retention programs, materials, on-the-job training opportunities)	
(2) Number of students to be directly supported by this grant (i.e., scholarships, fellowships, paid on-the-job training opportunities, included as a cost in your project budget)	
(3) Number of students who will indirectly benefit from the products produced from the grant during the grant period (i.e., using the curriculum/ instrumentation, enrolled in the program, recruited or retained but not paid by the grant using scholarships, fellowships and assistantships).	

3. Food and Agriculture Non-formal Education grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative section may not exceed ten-pages of written text using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative must include all of the following (see page and font restrictions noted above):

1) **Specific Application Type Information**
    a. Resubmissions – Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO.)
    b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
        i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative.
        ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
2) **Overview**
    a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the program to be developed; the AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area(s) and technology being addressed; the anticipated project audience; the project's objectives; timetable; and participating organizations' commitment to the activity.
    b. Summarize the body of knowledge justifying the need for the proposed project. Describe any ongoing or recently completed, significant activities related to the proposed project.
3) **The Extension Environment**
    a. For the project director, the faculty who may serve as mentors, and the institution(s) or organization(s) where the activities will occur, describe their experience(s) working with youth, specifically their experience in implementing positive youth development strategies.
    b. Describe the experience of key personnel in providing quality nonformal education in agricultural technology.
    c. Fully describe the institutional support/partnerships for the proposed project. How does the proposed project

align with and contribute to the applicant and partner institutions' goals for enhancing understanding of agricultural technology in their community/state/region? Projects that involve partnerships with local government, economic development organizations, and nonprofit organizations are encouraged.

d. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for participants with disabilities, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.

4) Approach

a. Youth Involvement
   i) The proposed involvement of youth in the design, execution, and evaluation of activities that promote learning about agricultural technology should be described with as much specificity as possible, including utilization of appropriate youth development strategies, and a whole-child approach.

b. Outreach Materials Development
   i) Describe what element of outreach and materials the project will pursue to clearly communicate the demonstrated benefits of agricultural technology, the safety record of the regulatory system, and how technology can address agricultural challenges.
   ii) Describe the proposal's creative approach to cultivate interest and build public confidence in the safe and enhanced use of technology in agriculture and food systems. Use either actual experiences and/or literature to show why you selected this approach.

c. Plan of Operation and Methodology
   i) Applications should provide detailed descriptions of the extension activities that will be pursued. This discussion should indicate how these activities will lead to interest and build public confidence in the safe and enhanced use of technology in agriculture and food systems.
   ii) Describe procedures for accomplishing the objectives of this project. Describe plans for management of the project to ensure its proper and efficient administration. Describe the way in which resources and personnel will be used to conduct the project.

iii) Identify all important project milestones (performance metrics that indicate when project goals will be met) and dates as they relate to project start-up, execution, evaluation, dissemination, and closeout.

iv) (If applicable) Recruitment, Selection, and Continued Support for Participants. The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible. How will participants be recruited? What criteria will be used to select participants?

5) Project Evaluation and Reporting

a. Clearly define a plan with a timeline to extensively evaluate the project using formative and summative assessment tools that can help inform future implementations of agricultural technology nonformal education programs. Identify pitfalls and limitations to proposed approaches and how these will be addressed;

b. Define the approach for tracking how the development of the consumer-friendly content builds confidence in the safe use of technology in agricultural and food systems;

c. Describe how potential adoption of the agricultural technology will be utilized by other institutions and/or organizations.

d. Specifically describe the youth-centered learning outcomes (e.g. skills or knowledge obtained, interest and competencies in STEM and food and agricultural sciences, etc.) and associated measures to evaluate outcomes;

e. Describe how these outcome measures were chosen; and

f. Provide strategies to assess, at the project-level, management of the project for successful outcomes.

6) Expected Outputs

Please use the table format below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of products to be developed through grant funds during the grant period (i.e., curricula, outreach materials)	
(2) Number of youth participants to be directly supported by this grant	

(3) Number of youth who will indirectly benefit from the products produced from the grant during the grant period (i.e. using the materials, enrolled in the project)	

4. Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of ten-pages of written text using 12- point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not used a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative (see page and font restrictions noted above)

1) **Specific Application Type Information**
   a. Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO)
   b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
      i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative.
      ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
   c. Progress Report (Only applies to proposals building on previously awarded REEU projects). This requirement only applies to project directors who are submitting a proposal in the current FY competition AND who have held an REEU award in the last five years. These applications must include a progress report within the applicable page limitation of the Project Narrative and should

highlight program accomplishments, evaluation outcomes, and resulting adjustments and developments in the program's scope and logistics (if any). This section should be labeled "Progress Report."

2) **Overview**
   a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the proposed host site(s)/location(s), intended student participants, intellectual focus, organizational structure, timetable, and participating organizations' commitment to the activity.

3) **The Research, Education and/or Extension Environment**
   a. For the project director, the faculty who may serve as mentors, and the institution(s) or organization(s) where the activities will occur, describe the experience, and the record of the involvement with undergraduate students. Include information on the record of faculty/mentors in publishing work involving undergraduate authors and in providing professional development opportunities for undergraduate students.
   b. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for students with disabilities, accessibility, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.

4) **Approach**

   The Approach **must** include the following:
   a. Student Recruitment, Selection, and Retention
      i) The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible, including the types and/or names of academic institutions where students will be recruited.
      ii) The number of students per project should be appropriate to the institutional or organizational setting and to the way research is conducted in the discipline.
      iii) Indicate how undergraduate fellows, who leave the program early, will be replaced.
   b. Nature of Student Activities
      i) Proposals should address the approach to undergraduate research, education and/or extension training being taken and should provide detailed descriptions of the research, education and/or extension projects that the undergraduate students will pursue. This discussion should indicate the significance of the research, education and/or extension

area(s) and, when appropriate, the underlying theoretical framework, hypotheses, and questions.

ii) Proposals must present plans that will ensure the development of student faculty interaction and student-student communication.

c. Institutional Support

i) Fully describe the institutional support for the proposed training. How does the proposed project align with the institution's goals for experiential learning? How does the proposed project contribute to achieving these goals?

5) Project Evaluation and Reporting

a. Clearly define a plan with a timeline to extensively evaluate the project using formative and summative assessment tools that can help inform future implementations of experiential learning programs. Identify pitfalls and limitations to proposed approaches and how these will be addressed;

b. Define the approach for longitudinal tracking of the students after completion of the Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates program; include strategies for tracking Fellows to their exit point from the institution; and if employed where and at what level, if graduate training then what institutions and in what level/areas of study etc.;

c. Specifically describe the student-centered learning outcomes (e.g., skills or knowledge obtained, presentations and publications, graduation rates, students matriculating to graduate schools, etc.) and associated measures to evaluate outcomes;

d. Describe how these outcome measures were chosen; and

e. Provide strategies to assess, at the project-level, management of the project for successful outcomes.

6) Expected Outputs

Please use the table format below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of students to be directly supported by this grant (i.e., scholarships, fellowships, assistantships, internships included as a cost in your project budget) for undergraduate education	

(3) Number of female students to be directly supported by this grant(i.e., scholarships, fellowships, assistantships, internships included as a cost in your project budget) for undergraduate education	
(5) Number of students supported by this grant (i.e., scholarships, fellowships, assistantships) who are pursuing:	
5-A. Two-year or other certificates	
5-B. Four-year Undergraduate degrees	
(6) Number of student domestic experiences, with a government or non- governmental organization that is not affiliated with your university, to be supported by this grant	

5. Pre and Post-doctoral Fellowships grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

1) For Predoctoral Grant applications, the Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of six-pages using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).
2) For Postdoctoral Grant applications, the Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of ten-pages using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

NOTE: The project narrative attachment includes: Response to Previous Review (for resubmitted applications ONLY); Training/Career Development Plan; Mentoring Plan; Project Plan; and Evaluation Plan. All components will be considered in accordance with the Part V. B Evaluation Criteria.

1) Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted

Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO)

a. A maximum one-page response to the previous review. Include:
   i) Previous proposal number.
   ii) "Response to Previous Review" as the title on the first page of the project narrative attachment.
b. The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
c. The "Response to Previous Review" is not applicable to new applications (**see Part II § B of the NOFO)**.

2) Training/Career Development Plan

The Training/Career Development Plan is a statement of career goals and a description of fellowship activities, knowledge, and skills that will lead to career independence.

This Career Development Plan must include:

a. A personal statement addressing overall career goals and objectives;
b. A description of *specific* fellowship activities to achieve professional goals and objectives;
c. Any other extension, education, and/or research activities (e.g., teaching in formal or informal settings, cross-disciplinary collaborations, etc.) to enhance career development;
d. Explanation of new knowledge and skills expected from the fellowship activities;
e. Plans for transition to career independence.

3) Mentoring Plan

The applicants are expected to identify a Primary Mentor who will be willing to help them in their application and projects as well as professional development (more than one Primary Mentor is acceptable for Integrated Projects only). If there are other collaborating mentors, their role and responsibilities to the project and development of the applicant's skills should be clearly described. For predoctoral applications, if the primary mentor is not the student's graduate advisor or laboratory sponsor, the relationship between advisor's work and the primary mentor's research should be clearly defined, and the contribution of each individual in the student's project as well as degree completion should be included. The commitment of the mentor(s) is included in the evaluation criteria as it pertains to project personnel.

In describing the role of the mentor, *the applicant should*:

a. Indicate how the mentoring and educational training will add to the skill sets and help in achieving professional goals and objectives.
b. Articulate *specific* mentoring activities the mentor and applicant will be engaged in, including specific deliverables from these activities and how/why these activities were chosen.
c. Explain the role and commitment of the primary mentor.
d. If applicable, briefly describe the role of collaborating mentors.
e. With respect to the Primary Mentor, provide specifics on what the mentor will do and where applicable highlight successes of past mentees relevant to the proposal and career aspiration of the PD (do not just list all previous mentees).

***NOTE*:** The Primary Mentor *must* submit a Letter of Commitment (as an attachment to Field 12, Other Attachments, of the Other Project Information form) explicitly indicating their respective responsibilities throughout the proposed project in relation to the Project Director.

4) Project Plan

Predoctoral Applicants: It is expected that predoctoral students will be working with a primary mentor or advisor who has funded research and that the fellow may work on another aspect of this research. Moreover, the mentor/advisor will already have the facilities, equipment, technologies, and methodologies for the projects developed with the fellow.

a. Experimental methods, especially if these are routinely or generally used, do not need detailed description. However, sufficient details on the experimental approach or strategy as well as pitfalls must be provided to allow assessment of feasibility of study.
b. The Project scope should be within the 3-year timeframe of the fellowship.

Postdoctoral Applicants: The research should be clearly differentiated from the mentor's work. The applicant should describe the portability of the research and outline what from this work will go with them in a new role. Clearly articulate how this project and the data that comes from it will help foster career independence. Proven techniques and technologies as part of the experimental approach, especially if these are routinely employed, do not have to be provided in detail (but should be appropriately cited).

a. Experimental approaches or strategies including possible pitfalls and alternatives must be provided to assess the overall feasibility of the

proposed study.

b. The scope of the project should be within the 2-year timeframe.

Project Plans should contain the following:

a. Introduction
   i) Include a well-defined problem, a clear statement of the long-term goal(s) and supporting objectives of the proposed project.
   ii) Summarize the body of knowledge or other past activities that substantiate the need for the proposed project.
   iii) Describe ongoing or recently completed activities related to the proposed project including the work of key project personnel.
   iv) Include preliminary data/information pertinent to the proposed work.
   v) All works cited should be referenced (see Bibliography & References Cited).

b. Rationale and Significance
   i) Concisely present the rationale behind the proposed project and how it will advance the current knowledge in the field;
   ii) Clearly describe the specific relationship of the project's objectives to the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area as identified in the Project Summary/Abstract.

c. Approach
   Provide a concise description of the proposed project and the problem(s) to be addressed. Clearly describe the approaches to be used. Specifically, this section must include:
   i) A description of the project details proposed and the sequence in which the activities are to be performed;
   ii) Methods to be used in carrying out the proposed project and feasibility of the methods (detail only if a new and unproven method is to be used; if employing commonly used methods provide information on the expertise available);
   iii) Expected outcomes and outcome measures;
   iv) Means by which results will be analyzed, assessed, or interpreted;
   v) How results or products will be used;
   vi) Discuss any potential pitfalls that may be encountered, and how they will be addressed;
   vii) Limitations to proposed procedures;
   viii) A full explanation of any materials, procedures, situations, or

activities related to the project that may be hazardous to personnel, along with an outline or precautions to be exercised to avoid or mitigate the effects of such hazards;

ix) A timeline for attainment of objectives and for production of deliverables with specific, measurable outcomes.

5) Evaluation Plan

Applicants must provide a plan for evaluating progress towards fellowship objectives related to the training/career development plan, mentoring plan, and project plan. In developing evaluation plan components related to the project type, the applicant may refer to the AFRI Project Types resource on the AFRI Notice of Funding Opportunities Resources page. The fellowship evaluation plan should include:

a. Milestones, which signify the completion of major deliverables, events, and accomplishments.
b. Measurable indicators to verify that the fellowship is on schedule and on track for successful conclusion.
c. A dissemination plan describing the methods that will be used to communicate findings and fellowship accomplishments.
d. A description of how the fellowship proposal aligns with the Predoctoral and Postdoctoral Fellowship program aim of cultivating future leaders who can solve emerging agricultural challenges.

6. Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of ten-pages of written text using 12- point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative (see page and font restrictions noted above)

1) Specific Application Type Information

a. Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO)

b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:

   i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative.

   ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.

c. A mentoring plan is not required.

2) Introduction

Include a clear statement of the long-term goal(s) and supporting objectives of the proposed project. Summarize the body of knowledge or past activities that substantiate the need for the proposed project. Describe ongoing or recently completed activities significant to the proposed project including the work of key project personnel. Include preliminary data/information pertinent to the proposed project. This section should include in-depth information on the following, when applicable:

a. Estimates of the magnitude of the issues and the relevance to stakeholders and ongoing state-federal food and agricultural research, education, and extension programs;

b. The role of stakeholders in problem identification, planning, implementation, and evaluation, as appropriate; and

c. Reasons for performing the work at the proposed institution.

All works cited should be referenced (see Bibliography & References Cited in Part IV § C3(c)), below).

3) Rationale and Significance

a. Concisely present the rationale behind the proposed project;

b. Describe the specific relationship of the project's objectives to one of the AFRI EWD Program Area Priorities. Applications that do not address at least one AFRI EWD Program Area Priority will not be reviewed; and

c. Clearly describe the potential long-range improvement in and sustainability of U.S. agriculture and food systems. These purposes are described under Purpose and Priorities in Part I § B of the NOFO. Any novel ideas or contributions that the proposed

project offers should also be discussed in this section.

4) **Approach**
   a. A justification for the meeting;
   b. Recent meetings on the same subject with dates and locations;
   c. Names and organizational affiliations of the chair and other members of the organizing committee;
   d. A proposed program (or agenda) for the workshop, including a listing of scheduled participants and their institutional affiliations; and
   e. The method of announcement or invitation that will be used.

C. Field 9. Bibliography & References Cited

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Bibliography & References Cited' in the document header and save file as 'BibliographyReferencesCited'.

All work cited in the text should be referenced in this section of the application. All references must be complete; include titles and all co-authors; conform to an acceptable journal format; and be listed in alphabetical order using the last name of the first author or listed by number in the order of citation.

D. Field 10. Facilities & Other Resources

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Facilities & Other Resources' in the document header and save file as 'FacilitiesOtherResources'.

E. Field 11. Equipment

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Equipment' in the document header and save file as 'Equipment'.

Describe available equipment. Items of nonexpendable equipment necessary to conduct and successfully complete the proposed project should be listed in Field C. of the R&R Budget and described in the Budget Justification (see Part IV§ C.6 below).

F. Field 12. Other Attachments

The following instructions are in addition to those noted in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

1. **Key Personnel Roles**

   2-Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Key Personnel' and save file as 'KeyPersonnel'.

a. *For Integrated Grant Applications* – state for key personnel an estimate of the percent of time devoted to research, education, and/or extension activities.

Clearly describe the roles and responsibilities of the PD, collaborator(s), etc. (biographical sketches for key personnel including mentor(s) should not be included here). If it will be necessary to enter into formal consulting or collaborative arrangements with others, such arrangements should be fully explained and justified. Evidence (letters of support) for this type of collaboration should be provided in the 'Documentation of Collaboration' attachment (see item 6 below).

2. Logic Model

2-Page Limit. **Required for all Integrated Project applications. Encouraged for Research, Education, or Extension Project applications.** Title the attachment as 'Logic Model' and save file as 'LogicModel'.

Include the elements of a logic model detailing the activities, outputs, and outcomes of the proposed project. The logic model planning process is a tool that should be used to develop your project before writing your application. This information may be provided as a narrative or formatted into a logic model chart. For more information and resources, see Integrated Programs' Logic Model Planning Process.

Failure to include a logic model for an integrated project may result in the application not being considered for review.

3. Management Plan

2-Page Limit. **Required for Integrated Project applications. Encouraged for Research, Education, or Extension Project applications.** Title the attachment as 'Management Plan' and save file as 'ManagementPlan'.

The plan is to be clearly articulated and include an organizational chart, administrative timeline, and a description of how the project will be governed, as well as a strategy to enhance coordination, collaboration, communication, and data sharing and reporting among members of the project team and stakeholder groups. The plan must also address how the

project will be sustained beyond the award end date.

The management plan must also include an advisory group of principal stakeholders, partners, and professionals to assess and evaluate the quality, expected measurable outcomes, and potential impacts for the proposed research, education and/or extension. Please include rationale for their role, and how they will function effectively to support the goals and objectives of the project. The plan must demonstrate how partners and stakeholders contribute to project assessment on an annual basis.

4. **Data Management Plan (DMP)**
   2-Page Limit. Required for all applications. Title the attachment as 'Data Management Plan' and save file as 'DataManagementPlan'.

   Clearly articulate how the project director (PD) and co-PDs plan to manage and disseminate the data generated by the project. The DMP will be considered during the merit review process (see Part V § B of the NOFO). See Part V.320, of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for NIFA attachment specifications.

   For the guidelines on preparation and inclusion of a DMP in your application, see Data Management Plan for NIFA-Funded Research, Education and Extension Projects at NIFA website. Also included on the web page are FAQs and information about accessing examples of DMPs. In addition, general guidelines for Data Management Planning for USDA agencies are available at the National Agricultural Library website.

5. **Mentoring Plan (MentP)**
   A Mentoring Plan is required for all grant types (except Workshop Grants) that involve student or participant training or mentoring. The guidelines below apply to all grant types except Predoctoral Fellowships and Postdoctoral Fellowships, which have their own unique mentoring requirements within the Field 8. Project Narrative attachment.

   Title the attachment as 'Mentoring Plan' and save file as 'MentoringPlan'.

   There is a 2-page limit for standard grant applications. Mentoring plans should be included as a separate attachment and uploaded to field 12 of the grant application. All student types should be included in the same mentoring plan.

The Mentoring Plan should describe:

1) past or proposed training of individuals who will serve as mentors including equipping, mentoring, or monitoring activities they have received or will receive to help them effectively mentor students and trainees during the project;
2) the groups of students or individual trainees to be mentored on the project, including students grades 9-12, undergraduate students, graduate students, postdoctoral scholars, professionals and any other individuals to be trained or mentored on the project;
3) detailed mentoring activities to be delivered throughout the project to each distinct category or group of students and/or trainee participants, including those activities provided through research, education, Extension or outreach efforts; and
4) expected outcomes derived from the mentoring activities and prospective impact(s) on the food and agricultural sciences.

6. Documentation of Collaboration

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Documentation of Collaboration' in the document header and save file as 'Collaboration'.

Include evidence of collaboration and contributions amongst the host institution and partners.

Evidence, *e.g.*, letter(s) of support, must be provided that the collaborators involved have agreed to render services, including letters of commitment for subcontracts. The applicant also will be required to provide additional information on consultants and collaborators in the budget portion of the application.

7. Preprints

Limited to 2 preprints. Title the attachment as 'Preprints' in the document header and save file as 'Preprints'.

Preprints related to the Project Narrative are allowed if they are directly germane to the proposed project. Information may not be appended to an application to circumvent page limitations prescribed for the Project Narrative. Extraneous materials will not be used during the peer review process. Only manuscripts in press for a peer- reviewed journal will be

accepted and must be accompanied by letters of acceptance from the publishing journals. Preprints attached in support of the application must be single-spaced. Each preprint must be identified with the name of the submitting organization, the name(s) of the PD(s), and the title of the application.

8. **Minority-Serving Institution Documentation**
   Optional: May be needed if applying for a FASE Strengthening Standard Grant.
   Title the attachment as 'Minorityinfo' in the document header and save file as 'Minorityinfo'.
   1) Letter identifying percentage of applicable minority students.
   2) Request for Determination of Status– see Part III § B of the NOFO.

9. **Mentor and Reference Letters (Pre and Post-doctoral Fellowships)**
   1) **Primary Mentor Commitment Letter**
      One Primary Mentor letter is required. If there is more than one Primary Mentor (Integrated Projects Only), a Primary mentor letter should be provided for each mentor. The mentor letter(s) should indicate:
      a. the quality of the applicant in regard to their ability to develop into a leader in food and agriculture;
      b. the applicant's oral and written communication skills and critical and analytical skills;
      c. the applicant's level of intellectual independence;
      d. the role of the student and mentor in the development of the application;
      e. their respective committed responsibilities throughout the proposed project in relation to the Project Director;
      f. a statement that the research by the applicant is independent and not an extension of the mentor's research (for postdoctoral applicants only); and
      g. any other pertinent and relevant information to indicate the applicant is deserving of being awarded a prestigious AFRI EWD Pre- or Post-doctoral Fellowship.
   2) **Collaborating Mentor Letter(s)**
      Other mentor letter(s) should generally comment on the items listed above for the Primary Mentor Letter of Commitment, limited to one page.

3) **Reference Letters(s)**
Three reference letters are required. Letters should not come from identified mentor(s) but must be obtained from other individuals who know the applicant well to substantially speak towards the applicant's academic and research accomplishments and ability to complete the doctoral degree program, or undertake an independent postdoctoral research, education, extension, or integrated research, education and/or extension project. Reference letters should be no longer than one- page.

4) **Academic Standing**
   a. For **predoctoral applications,** documentation from the graduate advisor, graduate committee or the institution indicating that the applicant has advanced to candidacy, as per institutional requirements, by the date specified in the EWD NOFO.
   b. For **postdoctoral applications**, documentation from the graduate advisor, graduate committee or the institution that all doctoral degree requirements were satisfied by the date specified in the EWD NOFO.

4) R&R Senior/Key Person Profile (Expanded)

Detailed information related to the questions on this form is available in Part V.130 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide. This section of the guide includes instructions about the people who require senior/key person profile, and details about the biographical sketch and the current and pending support, including a link to the suggested template for the current and pending support.

A Senior/Key Person Profile must be completed for the PD and each co-PD, senior associate, and other professional personnel, including collaborators playing an active role in the project. Collaborators only providing services or materials should not be listed in the R&R Senior/Key Person Profile. Evidence (letters of support) for this type of collaboration should be provided in the Documentation of Collaboration (see Part IV § C.3(f6)).

G. Project Role Field
Complete appropriately.

H. Other Project Role Category Field
Complete appropriately, if applicable.

I. Attach Biographical Sketch Field
2-Page Limit (excluding publications listings) per PD, co-PD, senior associate, and other professional personnel. Title the attachment as 'Biographical Sketch' in

the document header and save file as 'BiographicalSketch' followed by the last name of the PD or co-PD such that each biographical sketch file in the application has a distinct file name.

The Biographical sketch of the applicant (PD) and each co-PD, senior associate, and other professional personnel must be included. In addition, include:

1. Author identifier (ORCID, https://orcid.org) of the researcher if available.
2. Digital Object Identifier (DOI) of all publications where possible.

If applicable, the application must include a list of data publications or published data products relevant to the proposed project, following recommended data citation format.

In addition, Biographical sketch must include:

1. A presentation of academic, extension, and/or research credentials including, as applicable: earned degrees, teaching experience, employment history, professional activities, honors and awards, and grants received; and
2. The number of continuing education courses developed and taught/trained the number of educators by the applicant.
3. All relevant publications in refereed journals during the past four (4) years including those in press.

The Conflict of Interest list must not be included in the biographical sketch, but it must be provided as a separate document (see Part IV § C.7(b) for more information).

J. Attach Current and Pending Support Field

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Current and Pending Support' in the document header and save file as 'CurrentPendingSupport'.

The suggested template for Current and Pending Support is located on the NIFA Application Support Templates page ("Current & Pending Support" in the attachments list). Current and Pending Support information is only required for the PD and co-PDs identified.

Note: Even if no other funding is currently reported under the 'Active' section of this attachment, each senior/key person must list this grant application under

the 'Pending' section of this attachment.

As an addendum to the Current and Pending Support, provide a brief summary for any completed, current, or pending projects that appear similar to the current application.

5) **R&R Personal Data**
As noted in Part V.140 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide, the submission of this information is voluntary and is not a precondition of award. Part V.140 also notes the importance and use of the information.

6) **R&R Budget**
Detailed information related to the questions on this form is available in Part V.150 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

K. Matching Funds

Applicants MUST provide matching contributions on a dollar-for-dollar basis for all Federal funds awarded under AFRI for applied research grants or integrated projects with an applied research component.

If you conclude that matching funds are not required as specified under Part III § C of the NOFO, Cost Sharing or Matching, you must include an explanation for your conclusion in the Budget Justification. We will consider this justification when determining final matching requirements or if required matching can be waived. NIFA retains the right to make final determinations regarding matching requirements.

For grants that require matching funds as specified under Part III § C of the NOFO, the Budget Justification must list matching sources along with the identification of the entity(ies) providing the match as well as the total dollar amount being pledged. NIFA is no longer requiring written verification of commitments of matching support (a pledge agreement). However, you are still subject to documentation, valuing and reporting requirements, etc. as specified in 2 CFR Part 200, "Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards (the Uniform Guidance)," 7 CFR 3430, "Competitive and Noncompetitive Non-Formula Federal Assistance Programs – General Award Administrative Provisions," and program-specific regulations, as applicable. In instances where match is required, any resulting award will require the signature of an Authorized Representative. Only when NIFA receives the award signed by the AR will award funds be released and available for drawdown.

The sources and the amount of all matching support from outside the applicant organization must be summarized on a separate page and placed in the application immediately following the Budget Justification. If included, although not required, all pledge agreements must be placed in the application immediately following the summary of matching support.

Establish the value of applicant contributions in accordance with applicable cost principles. Refer to 2 CFR Part 200, "Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards," for further guidance and other requirements relating to matching and allowable costs.

L. Budget Periods

Applications must contain a budget for each budget period for the entire duration of the proposed project. Annual and cumulative budgets are required.

If a PDAL, AWT, FANE, or REEU application is funded, the Project Director will be required to attend one AFRI EWD Project Directors' meetings during the performance period of the award.

If a Predoctoral fellowship grant application is funded, the Project Director will be required to attend one AFRI Fellows Project Directors' meeting during the performance period of the award.

Postdoctoral fellowship Project Directors are required to attend one AFRI Fellows Project Directors' meeting AND a PD meeting of the Foundational and Applied Science program area priority with which the project is most closely aligned during the performance period of the award.

Reasonable travel expenses (location to be determined by NIFA program staff) should be included as part of the project budget.

See Part I § C of the NOFO for limitation of budget amounts, use of funds, and budget periods.

1. For Integrated Project Applications, projects must budget sufficient resources to carry out the proposed set of research, education, and/or extension activities that will lead to the desired outcomes. No more than two-thirds of a project's budget may be focused on a single component.
2. For Workshop Grant Applications, the budget for the workshop may include an

appropriate amount for transportation and subsistence costs for participants and for other workshop-related costs. NIFA will not support Workshop Grants with the sole purpose of supporting travel or to be implemented as subawards for travel grants. Workshop Grant awards must not exceed $50,000 and are not renewable. Indirect costs are not permitted on Workshop Grant awards. Include an itemized breakdown of all support requested from AFRI EWD in the Budget Justification (Field K. of the R&R Budget).

M. Subcontract Arrangements

If it will be necessary to enter into a formal subcontract agreement with another institution, then refer to the following items.

1. Letters of commitment (including proposed amount of subaward) and statement of work are required to be included in the application for each subaward. Letters of commitment are to be included in Field 12, Other Attachments of the R&R Other Project Information.
2. If the cumulative amount for subawards exceeds 50 percent of the total Federal funds requested or in instances where the proposed subaward is to a Federal agency, then the applicant must provide budgetary detail (i.e., budget and budget justification) for each subaward. If this is the case then refer to Part V.150 Section H. of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for instructions on how to include this information as part of the application.

N. Field H. Indirect Costs

See Part V.150 Section H of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for details, and Part IV § D of the NOFO for additional information.

O. Field K. Budget Justification

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Budget Justification' in the document header and save file as 'BudgetJustification'.

All cumulative budget categories, with the exception of Indirect Costs, for which support is requested must be individually listed (with costs) in the same order as the cumulative budget. If consulting, collaborative, or sub contractual arrangements are included in the application, these arrangements should be fully explained and justified. The rate of pay for any consultant must be included, if known at the time of application. Please include a cost breakdown for the consultant, including the number of days in service, travel, and per diem, as well as the rate of pay. Letters of consent or collaboration signed by the Authorized Representative and other evidence should be provided in the Documentation of Collaboration (see Part IV § C.3(f6)) to show that collaborators have agreed to participate. A proposed statement of work, biographical sketch, and a budget for each arrangement involving the transfer of substantive programmatic work or the provision of financial assistance to a third party must be supplied. Allowable expenditures must be appropriately discussed in the

budget justification. In multi- institutional applications, a budget and budget narrative must be included for each institution involved. The lead institution and each participating institution must be identified.

1. *For Integrated Project Applications* – Each function should be represented by one or more objectives within the application. Projects must budget sufficient resources to carry out the proposed set of research, education, and/or extension activities that will lead to the desired outcomes. No more than two-thirds of a project's budget may be focused on a single component.

7) Supplemental Information Form

Instructions related to this form are explained in detail in Part VI.300 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

P. Field 2. Program to which you are applying

Enter the Program Code Name and the Program Code for the Program Area to which you are applying from the information provided in the Program Area Descriptions beginning in Part I § C of the NOFO. An application can only be submitted to one program area. Note that accurate entry of the Program Code Name and Program Code is extremely important for proper and timely processing of application. Failure to enter this information correctly may result in your application not being retrieved on time for review and subsequently not being considered for funding. If you have a question about which topic area is appropriate for your application, please contact the Program Area Contact.

Q. Field 8. Conflict of Interest List

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Conflict of Interest' in the document header and save file as 'Conflict of Interest'. See Part V.300 Field 8 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

A Conflict of Interest List is required for all applications submitted to the AFRI EWD NOFO. The Conflict of Interest List should be provided as a separate PDF attachment and not included in the vitae or resume. A Conflict of Interest List must be completed individually for all personnel who have submitted a Biographical Sketch in the R&R Senior/Key Personnel Profile. **Collate all individual Conflict of Interest lists into a single document file.** The lists can only be submitted as a single PDF attachment.

The required template for the Conflict of Interest List is located on the NIFA Application Support Templates page ("Conflict of Interest List" in the attachments list)